Malayalam RLHF Annotation & Review Guide

Mercor · Neon Origin Indic Generalist RLHF, Phase 2 · SuperAnnotate (ML_General queue)

A complete working reference for writing annotations (strengths, areas of improvement, scores, preference) and for quality-checking other annotators' work, built from every rule, decision and correction made across our annotation sessions.

Read this first

Where this comes from. The original guideline documents you shared were in an earlier chat, and their full text is not available here. This guide is rebuilt from what survives: my confirmation of those guidelines at the start of our sessions, the language-scoring rules you pasted, your team lead's guidance, and every decision and correction we made on Tasks 1–20 (as annotator and as reviewer).

How to read it. Items marked **[Rule]** come from the guidelines or team lead. Items marked **[Practice]** are working decisions we settled on during tasks. Where the original document has details this guide cannot confirm (for example, what each letter of ICON-REAL stands for), it says so instead of guessing. If anything here conflicts with the official QRG or your team lead, follow them.

Contents

1. Project and platform overview
2. The annotation workflow, step by step
3. Task flags and skipping
4. Reading the prompt: instructions to check
5. Image and multi-turn tasks
6. Strengths
7. Areas of improvement (AOIs)
8. Severity: Substantial vs Minor
9. Language and script rules (score caps)
10. Scoring 1–5
11. Overall preference and reasoning
12. Sources, fact-checking and LLM use
13. Writing style rules
14. Decisions log: valid vs invalid AOIs
15. Reviewer / QC guide
16. Final pre-submit checklist
17. Copy-ready templates

1. Project and platform overview

1.1 The project

- **Project:** Mercor Neon Origin, Indic Generalist RLHF, Phase 2. Language: Malayalam. [Rule]
- **Platform:** SuperAnnotate, project queue **ML_General**. [Rule]
- **Task:** read a user prompt (often multi-turn, often with an image), evaluate two model responses (Response 1 and Response 2), write strengths and AOIs for each, score each from 1 to 5, and give an overall preference with a short reason. [Rule]
- **Annotation language:** everything you write is in **English**. The prompts and responses are in Malayalam script or Roman Malayalam (Manglish). [Rule]
- **Roles:** you began as an Annotator and were upgraded to Reviewer / Quality Checker (QC). As QC you still annotate the task yourself (your "ground truth") and then review three annotators' work. [Practice]

1.2 What the task screen shows

Element	What it is / how to use it
Task ID (e.g. v1_task_448d…)	Top-left dropdown. Use it to identify the task when asking your team lead.
Main Evaluation / Fact Checker tabs	Main Evaluation is where you annotate. Fact Checker helps you verify claims (game rules, prices, facts) before you call something an error.
Language / Modality tags	E.g. Language: Malayalam; Modality: image, text. Tells you whether an image must be checked.
Task Context (N prior turns)	Earlier conversation turns. Read them all: they define tone, script, style and facts the current responses must stay consistent with.
PROMPT	The final user turn you are evaluating against.
ATTACHED TO THE PROMPT	The image. Expand it and check every detail the responses mention.
Response 1 / Response 2 panels	May sit side by side. The panel header says which is which; confirm before writing.
Date/time ✗, Internet ✗, Cutoff 202501	Response capability tags: the model had no date/time or internet access, and a knowledge cutoff of January 2025. Keep this in mind for time-sensitive content.
Render plaintext	Shows raw text. Use it to check real formatting, e.g. whether ** bold marks are around only the action words.
Focus on prompt / Collapse all media	View helpers for long multi-turn tasks.
Check My Work → Verify with AI Judge	Automatic check listing MUST FIX items (All / R1 / R2 / Gen). Clear these before saving.
Save	Top-right. Save after finishing each section.

2. The annotation workflow, step by step

1. **Read all prior turns.** Note the script (Malayalam or Manglish), the style (e.g. English loanwords used freely), and any facts, advice or constraints set earlier (e.g. "avoid peanuts for allergies").
2. **Read the final prompt word by word.** List every explicit instruction: format, length, word or sentence counts, digits allowed or not, bold, no English words, "table only", "nothing else", order of points, tone.
3. **Study the image** (if any). Note objects, colours, shapes, counts, text printed on it, and anything that contradicts the user's text (e.g. the label says Pad Thai but the picture shows a

soup).

4. **Decide what an ideal response would contain.** This is your yardstick.
5. **Identify R1 and R2 correctly** from the panel headers.
6. **Read each response fully,** checking accuracy against the image, prompt and earlier turns; language and script; spelling and word choice; every instruction from step 2; and anything invented or unsupported.
7. **Verify facts** with the Fact Checker or approved sources before calling something wrong.
8. **Fill Task Flags** (Section 3).
9. **Write strengths** (Section 6), then **AOIs** (Section 7) for each response.
10. **Score each response** (Section 10), applying language caps (Section 9).
11. **Choose the preference** and write the reasoning (Section 11).
12. **Cross-check:** no strength contradicts an AOI; scores match the annotations; preference matches the scores.
13. **Run Check My Work**, fix the MUST FIX items, and Save.

3. Task flags and skipping

Each task asks whether certain conditions are true. In almost every task so far the correct choice was **"None of the above is true."** [Practice]

Flag condition	When it applies
Requires another language	The task needs a language other than the target and English to complete.
Requires expert knowledge (e.g. healthcare)	Answering well needs professional expertise. A beginner baby-care question did **not** qualify.
Requires special capabilities	E.g. tools or abilities the model cannot have.
Requires heavy research	Cannot be judged without extensive research.
Contains real-world PII	Real personal identifying information.
Unsafe content	Harmful or policy-violating content.
None of the above is true	Normal Malayalam task with clear instructions. The usual answer.

- **Should the task be skipped?** Normally **No**. [Practice]
- **Rationale box:** optional. Example: "The prompt is a standard Malayalam rewriting request with clear formatting instructions. It does not require another language, expert knowledge, special capabilities or heavy research, and it contains no real-world PII or unsafe content."
- **Do not flag** a task because the prompt or image contains a deliberate mismatch or trap (wrong label on a photo, contradictory times in a note). That is what is being tested.
- **Image will not load:** try expanding or refreshing. If it still fails, report to your team lead or the Slack support channel rather than guessing; the task may need to be skipped per project guidance. (Once, a copy of the image shared in Slack was used to check the task.)

4. Reading the prompt: instructions to check

Most Substantial AOIs in our tasks came from a missed explicit instruction. Check each response against every instruction below that the prompt contains.

Instruction type	What to check (examples from our tasks)
Output format	Numbered list vs paragraph, table only, exactly two paragraphs, one sentence per step, separate lines. A paragraph instead of the requested table is Substantial.

Instruction type	What to check (examples from our tasks)
"Nothing else" / "table only"	Extra intros, explanations or unchanged sentences break it. But if the user never forbids an intro, a short intro is **not** an error.
Counts	Exactly 3 sentences of exactly 4 words; word limits (e.g. under 40 or 50 words). Missing full stops can break a sentence count (Substantial).
Digits / lists / brackets banned	Numbers must be written in words when digits are banned; check every number, including times and ages.
Bold	If the user asks to bold only the action words, bolding whole sentences or no bold both fail. Verify with Render plaintext.
No English words	English terms left in when the user bans them = Substantial. Unavoidable loanwords with no Malayalam equivalent (e.g. "account" in the social-media sense) are not errors.
Script	Manglish prompt → Manglish answer; Malayalam-script prompt → Malayalam script (see Section 9).
Order	Points must follow the order the user specifies.
Keep original wording	For correction tasks: fix only errors, keep the user's words, greeting, closing and meaning. Changing meaning or adding words the user did not write is an AOI.
Content to preserve	Dropping details the user gave (items, times, events) is an AOI.

5. Image and multi-turn tasks

5.1 Image tasks

- Check every claim against the picture: object names, colours, shapes, counts, positions, quantities (e.g. "less than half the sand" in an hourglass), and printed text.
- Do not accept the user's description or the image label at face value; the picture is the evidence. Examples: one glass, not a bottle; a red bicycle, not blue; a round pookalam, not square; Kerala on the map, not Tamil Nadu; a noodle soup under a "Pad Tai Noneels" label.
- Misidentifying an object central to the question is Substantial (Charminar for Amber Fort; US map for Ticket to Ride Europe; earbuds called a stapler).
- Adding details that are not in the picture (a plastic cover, a fridge that is not visible, a specific fish species) is an AOI; invented specifics with no basis are hallucinations.
- Small wording slips that do not mislead (calling mugs "flowerpots") are Minor.
- If you cannot be sure of a detail (an item at the edge of the frame), say so in your notes and make your decision consistent across the annotation.

5.2 Multi-turn tasks

- Read every prior turn. The current response must stay consistent with earlier facts, advice and style.
- Earlier assistant turns set the accepted style. If they mixed English words into Manglish freely, English table headers are mild mixing (Minor), not a Substantial language failure.
- Earlier turns can make an item acceptable (e.g. the assistant earlier listed Marwari as a Rajasthan local language, so listing it again is consistent).
- Earlier turns can create obligations (e.g. after advising guests with peanut allergies, a dish usually served with peanuts deserves a reminder; missing it is Minor).
- Content that connects to the user's earlier concerns (e.g. stress tips after an anxious parent's earlier turns) is relevant, not off-topic.
- If earlier assistant turns used a different script from the prompt, the script cap still applies per the rule; ask your team lead if unsure.

6. Strengths

6.1 Format: two parts [Rule]

Strength structure

Part 1 — What: "The response ..." + the specific thing it does well, with a concrete example.

Part 2 — Why: "This improves the quality of the response by ..." + how it helps this user.

6.2 Rules

- Up to **3** strengths per response. [Rule]
- Always start with **"The response"**, never "The model" or "It". [Rule]
- Always end with **"This improves the quality of the response by..."**. [Rule]
- Must go **beyond baseline**. Never praise: correct grammar, correct spelling, using the correct language, understanding the user's intent, or simply having no errors. [Rule]
- **Never contradict an AOI.** Do not praise what an AOI criticises (e.g. do not say "the user can send it directly" if AOIs list errors in it; do not say "correctly identifies the rails" if an AOI says it overstates them). Praise only the part that is genuinely right. [Rule]
- Be specific: name the item, the instruction followed, or the detail from the image. Vague phrases like "a noodle word" or "attempts to" are weak; use exact descriptions and decisive verbs ("converts", not "attempts to convert").
- Merge two strengths that convey the same point into one.
- Only praise an instruction as followed if it is fully followed (partial bold is not "correctly bolds").
- Number of strengths should fit the score (Section 10). A score-1 response normally gets no strengths.

6.3 Example

Good: The response identifies "Noneels" as a wrong word and gives "Pad Thai" with the correct Malayalam spelling. This improves the quality of the response by giving the friend a name to print on the menu directly.

Bad: The response is written in good Malayalam and understands the question. (Baseline only, no why.)

7. Areas of improvement (AOIs)

7.1 Format: three parts [Rule]

AOI structure

Excerpt: the exact text from the response (copied, not retyped).

Description: "The response ..." + what is wrong, then what it should be instead (the fix).

Impact: "This degrades the quality of the response by ..." + how it affects this user.

Severity: Substantial or Minor.

7.2 Excerpt rules [Rule]

Situation	What goes in the Excerpt field
Error in a specific place	Copy that exact text from the screen (photos can misread characters).
Something is missing	(content missing)
Issue across the whole response	The first sentence … the last sentence. Never "(entire response)".
Malayalam text	Allowed only here, in the excerpt field.

7.3 Description rules

- Start with **"The response"**; end with **"This degrades the quality of the response by…"**. [Rule]
- **English only.** Never quote Malayalam in the description; describe it by meaning, e.g. "the word meaning 'stagnation'" or "the phrase meaning 'came to ask'". [Rule]
- **One issue per AOI.** Combining different problems is "stacking" and is flagged by reviewers. Several errors of the **same type** (e.g. multiple spelling errors) may be one AOI. A spelling error and a missing full stop are different issues. Wrong prices and wrong column content are different issues. [Rule]
- Name the specific error and the correct form. "Contains grammatical errors" without saying which is too vague.
- Keep descriptions to about one to two sentences plus the impact line.
- Use present tense.
- An AOI must point to something **clearly wrong or clearly missing**. Suggestions ("could clarify") and personal preferences are not AOIs.
- Do not raise an AOI for something the user never asked for (e.g. "lacks detailed guidance" when the user only asked to number the note).

7.4 Hallucinations and unsupported claims [Rule]

- When a response states information with no source and no basis (an invented figure, a fish species not identifiable from the photo, a claim about receipts), the description must include the exact sentence: **"This [X] information is unsupported."** Example: "This standby-power information is unsupported."
- Do **not** attach a source to a hallucination AOI.
- Hedged claims ("it is said that") or claims taken from the user's own chart or image are not hallucinations.

7.5 AOIs that need a source

- When an AOI says a fact is wrong (game rules, a dish description, a language fact), attach a real page URL that supports the correction (Section 12).
- The source must be relevant to the exact claim; e.g. a page about copper supplements does not support a claim about copper water bottles.

7.6 Example

Excerpt: (the exact line naming the dish)

Description: The response presents "Pad Thai Noodle Soup" as the correct English name, but Pad Thai is a dry stir-fried noodle dish, not a soup. This degrades the quality of the response by giving the friend an incorrect dish name to print on the menu.

Severity: Substantial · **Source:** a real page about Pad Thai

8. Severity: Substantial vs Minor

	Substantial	Minor
Definition [Rule]	Affects the core task, accuracy, or an explicit instruction.	Affects polish or readability; the user's goal is still met.

	Substantial	Minor
Examples from our tasks	Wrong monument / wrong game edition; wrong prices; English kept when banned; bold instruction ignored; paragraph instead of table; sentence count broken; meaning reversed by a negation; wrong colour or shape correction left uncorrected; detail the user specifically asked about is wrong (sand level); garbled text that makes an explanation unreadable; key correction misspelled into another word.	Single spelling errors that do not change meaning; one unclear word; slightly awkward phrasing; small unsupported extra (a hashtag); calling mugs flowerpots; missing a helpful but unrequested reminder; mild language mixing consistent with the conversation; overstating a safety feature when the response still stresses supervision.

- Judge severity by the impact on **this user's goal**, not by how the error looks.
- A misspelling becomes Substantial when it changes the meaning of the key word (e.g. "pig" spelled so it reads as a different word in the main correction).
- Be consistent: the same issue should get the same severity in your annotation and in your QC feedback.

9. Language and script rules (score caps)

These rules were provided to the team and apply to every task. [Rule]

#	Situation	Score effect
1	Response is in a completely different language (not the target, not English). E.g. prompt in Tamil, response in French.	Score = 1
2	Response is in English instead of the target language. Complete a full evaluation anyway.	Capped at 2
3	Same language but script mismatch: Roman Malayalam prompt → Malayalam-script response, or vice versa.	Capped at 3
4	Some language mixing (e.g. some foreign words) while still understandable.	Between 3 and 4 depending on impact

- Raise an AOI for the language or script problem so the cap is explained.
- Malayalam script inside a Manglish conversation breaks the established pattern (supports the AOI).
- Explicit "no English words" instructions are judged as instruction failures, not as casual mixing.
- Gray areas (earlier turns already used a different script; English headers vs "English response") → ask your team lead and note the alternative outcome (e.g. if both responses end up ≤ 2, the preference becomes Neither Response Valid).

10. Scoring 1–5

Score each response from 1 to 5 using the project's ICON-REAL scoring framework. [Rule] (The full definition of ICON-REAL is in the original guidelines and is not reproduced here.) The number and severity of your strengths and AOIs must match the score distribution. [Rule]

Score	What it looked like in our tasks [Practice]	Typical annotations
5	Fully meets every instruction; no areas of improvement.	Strengths only. **No AOIs**; a 5 with an AOI contradicts itself.
4	Meets the core task; only Minor issues.	2–3 strengths; Minor AOIs only.
3	Useful but with at least one Substantial issue, or capped at 3 by script mismatch.	Some strengths; one or more Substantial AOIs plus Minor ones.

Score	What it looked like in our tasks [Practice]	Typical annotations
2	Major failures on the core task, or capped at 2 (English response).	Few strengths (one is fine); several Substantial AOIs.
1	Unusable: wrong language, wrong object, garbled, ignores the task.	Normally **no strengths**.

- Apply language caps after judging content: the final score is the lower of the two.
- Your score must not contradict your own annotations (QC check: a 5 with an AOI should be 4).

11. Overall preference and reasoning

11.1 Choosing the preference [Practice, consistent across all tasks]

Score relationship	Preference used
Difference of 2 or more points	R_ is Much Better than R_
Difference of 1 point	R_ is Better than R_
Same score, but one is still clearly preferable	R_ is Slightly Better than R_
Both responses scored 2 or below	Neither Response is Valid

11.2 Writing the reason [Rule]

- **10–50 words.**
- **Comparative:** mention both R1 and R2 and the key difference between them.
- **Present tense.**
- **Do not restate the ranking** (do not write "R2 is better because..." as a label; explain the difference).
- Base it on the most important points (usually the Substantial AOIs and the best strengths).
- It must be accurate for each response. E.g. do not say "both miss the soup" if one response noticed it.
- Update it whenever you change an AOI, strength or score.

Example reason (about 48 words)

R2 gives the correct Malayalam spelling of Pad Thai and clear colour advice with reasons, but it misses that the picture shows a soup. R1 notices the soup but invents the name "Pad Thai Noodle Soup," garbles its colour explanation and misspells the Malayalam name.

12. Sources, fact-checking and LLM use

- **Approved AI tools:** only Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Overview may be used for research. [Rule]
- **Never paste LLM text** into annotations. Write everything yourself. [Rule]
- **Sources must be real page URLs** (e.g. a Wikipedia or official page). Never a Google search link and never AI Overview text. [Rule]
- Use the Fact Checker tab and official sources before marking a fact wrong (e.g. confirm game editions and rules).
- Hallucination AOIs get no source (Section 7.4).
- **Team lead guidance:** do not assume the user is in India. Region-specific answers (e.g. Indian brands) are expected only when the user states their location; otherwise US-based or general examples are acceptable. [Rule]

13. Writing style rules

- English only; Malayalam appears only in excerpt fields. [Rule]
- Every strength and AOI description starts with **"The response"**. [Rule]
- Strengths end with **"This improves the quality of the response by..."**; AOIs end with **"This degrades the quality of the response by..."**. [Rule]
- Present tense throughout.
- Simple, human-sounding sentences with clean grammar ("advice", not "advices"; "less than half of the sand", not "fewer than half of sand").
- Specific over vague: name the word by its meaning, the item, the instruction.
- Keep each entry short: one or two sentences plus the closing line.
- Copy excerpts exactly from the screen, including any stray foreign-script characters.

14. Decisions log: valid vs invalid AOIs

Precedents set during Tasks 1–20. Reuse them for consistency. [Practice]

Situation	Decision
"Account" (social-media sense) kept in Malayalam	Not an AOI; no clean Malayalam replacement.
User's note is self-contradictory (8-hour trip but 4:30 arrival)	Ambiguous. Either fix is defensible; treat changes to the timing as neutral or Minor, consistently for both responses.
Response adds a short intro the user never banned	Not an AOI.
Response changes the user's greeting, closing, or words in a correction task	AOI (meaning changed / words added).
Response introduces a misspelling the user had right	AOI; say the user's version was correct.
Misidentified item plus separate rule errors that are wrong in every version	Separate AOIs, since the rule errors are not caused by the misidentification.
Marwari listed as a local language of Rajasthan	Acceptable when earlier turns treated it as a local language/dialect.
English headers in a Manglish conversation that already mixes English	Minor language mixing, not Substantial.
Emotional/stress tips after anxious earlier turns	Relevant; not off-topic.
Slip-resistant pad advice framed as a "factual error"	Not a factual error; at most Minor missing detail.
Linking spectacles to writing/planning advice	Reasonable; not an AOI.
Hedged health claim based on the user's chart	Not a hallucination.
Image label contradicts picture (Pad Thai label, soup photo)	The ideal response notices it; missing it is Substantial; inventing a hybrid name is Substantial.
Unrequested safety reminder linked to earlier turns (peanuts)	Minor missed opportunity.
Strength says "user can send it directly" but AOIs list errors	Invalid strength (contradiction).
Two AOIs about the same missing content	Merge into one (avoid duplicates).

15. Reviewer / QC guide

15.1 QC workflow

1. Annotate the task yourself first. This is your **ground truth**.
2. Open each annotator's work (usually three annotators, for R1 and R2).
3. Vote on every strength and AOI, and on each score.
4. Fill the misses boxes.
5. Give each annotator an overall assessment with short feedback.

15.2 Votes on each item

Vote	Use when	Feedback pattern
✓ Agree	Correct, right severity, follows QRG.	None needed, or a short polish note.
! Needs fixing / partly valid	Right idea but: wrong severity, missing 'why', vague, Malayalam in the description, wrong excerpt type, overstated, stacked.	"This [strength/AOI] is valid, but …"
✗ Disagree	Wrong: not an actual error, contradicts the response or image, misreads the text, praises something the response fails.	"This [strength/AOI] is not valid because …"

15.3 What to check in each annotation

- Is the claim true for this response and image?
- Strength: two parts, starts with "The response", explains why, beyond baseline, no contradiction with AOIs.
- AOI: three parts, one issue, correct excerpt type ((content missing) / first…last), English-only description, correct severity, correct source use.
- Score: consistent with their own AOIs and with the language caps.
- Preference and reasoning: consistent with their scores, comparative, 10–50 words.
- Grammar, "The model" instead of "The response", past tense.
- Your votes must match your ground truth. If you change your ground truth, change your votes too.

15.4 Misses boxes

- **Substantial misses box (AOIs):** list only Substantial issues the annotator missed. Minor misses do not strictly belong there (optional note only).
- **Strength misses box:** note real strengths the annotator left out, briefly.
- If an annotator left a response completely empty, use the misses boxes to note what is missing.
- Leave a box empty when nothing Substantial is missed.

15.5 Final assessment of Annotators 1, 2 and 3

At the end of every review, each of the three annotators gets a final assessment. It has three parts: the decision, short written feedback, and ticked error types. Check this against your team lead's instructions if anything differs. [Practice]

Step 1 — Choose the decision

Decision	When to use
Approve	Strengths and AOIs are valid, follow the QRG structure, have correct severity and miss nothing important. **Rare.**

Decision	When to use
Approve with feedback	The core work is right and the key errors are caught, but there are fixable problems, like structure, severity, baseline strengths, Malayalam text in descriptions or small misses.
Disapprove	Substantial errors are missed, valid facts are flagged as wrong, scores clearly don't match the responses, or several AOIs are invalid.

Step 2 — Write the feedback

- Keep it **short and general**, in **1–2 sentences**.
- **Start with what they did well**, like "Good catch on…" or "The strengths are well written…"
- **Then say what to improve**, like "Please follow the QRG structure…", "Please check severity…" or "Please focus more on the content…"

Feedback examples

Approve with feedback: Good catch on the wrong sand level in R2. Please follow the QRG structure by explaining how each strength helps the user, and please check severity.

Disapprove: The strengths are well written. Please focus more on the content, as the main factual errors in R2 are missed and the only AOI flags a correct fact as wrong.

Step 3 — Tick the error types (only for Approve with feedback or Disapprove)

☐ Error type	Tick when the annotator…
☐ Instruction Following	Ignores the QRG structure, uses baseline strengths, gets severity wrong, stacks issues, puts Malayalam in descriptions, misses required strengths, or gives scores that don't match the QRG.
☐ Truthfulness	Flags correct facts as wrong, misses factual errors, or calls inaccurate content accurate.
☐ Clarity/Coherence	Writes unclear or contradictory annotations, has grammar or spelling errors, or praises something they also criticise.
☐ Length/Verbosity	Writes annotations that are far too long or padded, or goes over the 10–50 word limit for the justification.
☐ Safety	Misses or mishandles safety issues in the response.
☐ Other	Has a problem that doesn't fit the categories above, like a missing excerpt or a wrong task flag.

- **Tick every type that applies.**
- Most annotators need **Instruction Following**.
- **Truthfulness** is the main reason for a Disapprove.
- Do not tick any error types for a plain **Approve**.

Quick map: common problems → decision and ticks

Problem found	Likely decision	Tick
Strengths missing the 'why' / not starting with "The response"	Approve with feedback	Instruction Following
Wrong severity on one or two AOIs	Approve with feedback	Instruction Following
Malayalam quoted in AOI descriptions	Approve with feedback	Instruction Following
Two issues stacked in one AOI	Approve with feedback	Instruction Following
Score 5 with an AOI (score contradicts own annotation)	Approve with feedback	Instruction Following

Problem found	Likely decision	Tick
Grammar errors, "The model", contradictory strength and AOI	Approve with feedback	Clarity/Coherence
"(entire response)" or missing excerpt	Approve with feedback	Other
Overlong descriptions or justification over 50 words	Approve with feedback	Length/Verbosity
Substantial factual error missed in a response	Disapprove (or Approve with feedback if it is the only gap and the rest is strong)	Truthfulness
Correct fact flagged as wrong / only AOI invalid	Disapprove	Truthfulness
Several invalid strengths and AOIs; scores clearly off	Disapprove	Truthfulness + Instruction Following
Unsafe advice in a response not flagged	Disapprove or Approve with feedback, by impact	Safety

15.6 Feedback style [Rule — your saved preference]

- Keep feedback and Substantial-miss notes **short**: one or two sentences, focused.
- Item-level notes (on single strengths or AOIs) can be specific: "This AOI is valid, but the severity should be Minor." The final assessment feedback stays general (Step 2 above).

16. Final pre-submit checklist

- ■ R1 and R2 identified correctly from the panel headers.
- ■ All prior turns, the prompt and the image checked.
- ■ Task flags set (usually None of the above; skip = No).
- ■ Every explicit instruction checked in both responses.
- ■ Strengths: ≤ 3, two parts, "The response…", "This improves the quality of the response by…", beyond baseline.
- ■ AOIs: one issue each, exact excerpt / (content missing) / first…last, English description, fix stated, "This degrades the quality of the response by…", severity set.
- ■ Hallucinations use "This [X] information is unsupported." with no source.
- ■ Factual AOIs have real page URLs (no Google links, no AI Overview text).
- ■ No Malayalam in any description.
- ■ No strength contradicts an AOI.
- ■ Language/script caps applied.
- ■ Scores match annotations (5 = no AOIs; 1 = normally no strengths).
- ■ Preference matches the score gap; Neither Valid if both ≤ 2.
- ■ Reason: 10–50 words, comparative, present tense, no restated ranking, accurate for both.
- ■ Check My Work run; MUST FIX items cleared; saved.
- ■ (QC) Each annotator has a decision, 1–2 sentence feedback, and error types ticked (none for Approve).

17. Copy-ready templates

Strength: The response [does X, with a specific example]. This improves the quality of the response by [how it helps this user].

AOI: Excerpt: [exact text | (content missing) | first sentence … last sentence]

Description: The response [what is wrong]. It should [the fix]. This degrades the quality of the response by [impact on this user].

Severity: [Substantial | Minor] · Source: [real page URL if a fact is corrected; none for hallucinations]

Hallucination AOI: The response claims [X]. This [X] information is unsupported. It should [remove it or present it as uncertain]. This degrades the quality of the response by [presenting a guess as fact].

Preference reason: R_ [key strength], while [its main weakness]. R_ [its main failures].

QC — partly valid: This [strength/AOI] is valid, but [specific fix].

QC — invalid: This [strength/AOI] is not valid because [reason].

QC — missing why: This strength is valid but does not follow the QRG format, because it does not explain how it adds value for the user.

QC — Malayalam in description: This AOI is valid, but the description quotes Malayalam text, which should appear only in the excerpt field; it should explain the meaning in English.

QC — score contradiction: The score of 5 contradicts the annotator's own AOI and should be 4.